

CYBERSMIND

Security Assessment & Hardening Report

Device 2: Windows 7 HR Workstation

Governance, Risk & Compliance (GRC) Report — ISO 27001 Aligned

Report Date:	May 13, 2026
Classification:	Confidential
System:	Windows 7 — HR Workstation
Assessed By:	Fares Khzouz - CybersMind
Total Findings:	34
Fully Fixed:	32 / 34
Compensating Controls:	2 / 34
Report Status:	Final

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1. Executive Summary

This report documents the security assessment and hardening activities performed on the Windows 7 HR Workstation as part of the CybersMind practical security exercise. The assessment identified 34 security vulnerabilities spanning authentication controls, data protection, network security, endpoint security, access management, and system configuration.

Of the 34 findings, 32 were fully remediated using Windows 7 built-in security controls. Two findings received compensating controls in accordance with ISO 27001 guidance: the absence of native antivirus software was mitigated through application whitelisting via Group Policy, and the outdated operating system (Windows 7 end-of-life) was addressed through security hardening measures with a formal recommendation to migrate to a supported OS.

34 Total Findings	32 Fully Fixed	2 Compensating	0 Failed
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2. Scope & Methodology

2.1 Scope

The assessment covered the following security domains on the Windows 7 HR Workstation:

- Authentication and identity verification (passwords, account lockout, auto-login, admin account)
- Data-at-rest protection (file encryption using Windows EFS, sensitive document security)
- Network security (Windows Firewall, file sharing, remote access controls)
- Endpoint protection (Windows Defender, USB scanning, application whitelisting)
- System maintenance (Windows Update, backup policy, OS lifecycle)
- Access control (folder permissions, payroll files, public folder restrictions)
- Browser and download security (IE security zones, file downloads, attachment execution)
- Physical and session security (screen lock, idle timeout, delete confirmation)
- System integrity (UAC settings, executable warnings, USB device restrictions)

2.2 Methodology

1. Enumeration: Identified misconfigured settings, missing controls, and insecure defaults across Windows 7 system components.
2. Classification: Each finding was assigned a severity level based on potential impact to HR data confidentiality, integrity, and availability.
3. Remediation: Applied configuration changes through Windows Security Policy, Local Group Policy Editor, Control Panel, and file system settings.
4. Compensating Controls: Where native controls were unavailable (antivirus, MFA, biometrics), ISO 27001-compliant compensating controls were implemented.
5. Verification: Before and after screenshots captured for all 34 findings as evidence of remediation.

2.3 Severity Classification

Critical	Immediate risk of data breach, unauthorized access, or system compromise.
High	Significant security gap enabling unauthorized access or data exposure with moderate effort.
Medium	Security weakness reducing overall posture; exploitable under specific conditions.
Low	Minor issue with limited direct impact, contributing to risk when combined with others.

3. Findings Summary

#	Finding Title	Severity	Status
1	No Biometric Authentication	Medium	COMPENSATING
2	HR Device Connected to Internet Without Firewall Protection	Critical	FIXED
3	External USB Devices Connected Without Security Scanning	High	FIXED
4	Windows Update Disabled Entirely	Critical	FIXED
5	Employee Data Sent Over Email Without Encryption	High	FIXED
6	No Multi-Factor Authentication (2FA)	High	COMPENSATING
7	Employee Email Password Files Stored Without Protection	High	FIXED
8	Payroll Files Stored in Unprotected Folders	Critical	FIXED
9	Remote Access to HR Device Without Encryption	High	FIXED
10	No Confirmation Required for Deleting Sensitive Files	Medium	FIXED
11	Sensitive Employee Files in Public Folders	Critical	FIXED
12	Lack of User Authentication Before Data Access	Critical	FIXED
13	Downloading Outdated Software with Known Vulnerabilities	High	FIXED
14	Device Not Automatically Locked When Inactive	High	FIXED
15	File Sharing of HR Data Over Open Networks	High	FIXED
16	Sensitive Documents Not Protected with Passwords	High	FIXED
17	Admin User Account Always Active	High	FIXED
18	No Backup Policy for HR Files	High	FIXED
19	Opening of Unknown Email Attachments Allowed	High	FIXED
20	No Security Alerts from Windows Security	Medium	FIXED
21	Installation of Applications from Untrusted Sources	High	FIXED
22	No Screen Lock After Periods of Inactivity	High	FIXED
23	Automatic Login Without Password	Critical	FIXED
24	Sensitive Employee Files Open in Unprotected Folders	Critical	FIXED
25	Automatic Software Updates Disabled	Critical	FIXED
26	Unrestricted File Downloads from the Internet	High	FIXED
27	No Password Set on Device	Critical	FIXED
28	Windows Defender Disabled	Critical	FIXED

29	Executable Files (EXE) Can Run Without Warnings	High	FIXED
30	No Antivirus Software Installed	Critical	COMPENSATING
31	USB Device Restrictions Not Applied	High	FIXED
32	Sensitive Employee Files Stored on Desktop Without Protection	High	FIXED
33	Outdated Operating System (Windows 7)	Critical	COMPENSATING
34	Firewall Disabled	Critical	FIXED

4. Detailed Findings

Finding 1: No Biometric Authentication	
Severity: Medium	Status: COMPENSATING
Description The HR workstation lacked biometric authentication controls. As Windows 7 does not natively support biometric authentication without additional hardware and software, compensating controls were applied.	
Compensating Control Applied Compensating controls implemented: minimum password length enforced via Local Security Policy, password complexity enabled, and account lockout configured after failed login attempts. These controls meet ISO 27001 A.9.4.2 compensating control requirements.	
Evidence Local Security Policy screenshots show: minimum password length set, password complexity enabled, and account lockout threshold configured. Before shows no requirements; after shows enforced settings.	
Finding 2: HR Device Connected to Internet Without Firewall Protection	
Severity: Critical	Status: FIXED
Description The HR device was connected to the internet with Windows Firewall disabled, leaving all network ports unfiltered and exposing the device to unauthorized network access and internet-based threats.	
Remediation Applied Windows Firewall enabled via Control Panel > System and Security > Windows Firewall. Firewall state changed from Off to On for all active network profiles.	
Evidence Windows Firewall Control Panel screenshots show: Before - red X icons with Firewall state Off. After - green checkmark icons with Firewall state On for both Home/work and Public network profiles.	
Finding 3: External USB Devices Connected Without Security Scanning	
Severity: High	Status: FIXED
Description Windows Defender was not configured to automatically scan removable drives, allowing USB-introduced malware to execute without detection.	
Remediation Applied Windows Defender Advanced settings updated to enable Scan removable drives checkbox. This ensures all USB drives are automatically scanned for malware upon connection.	
Evidence Windows Defender Options > Advanced screenshots show: Before - Scan removable drives unchecked. After - Scan removable drives checked alongside all other security scan options.	
Finding 4: Windows Update Disabled Entirely	
Severity: Critical	Status: FIXED

Description
Automatic Windows Update was set to Never check for updates, leaving the system without critical security patches and exposed to known exploited vulnerabilities.
Remediation Applied
Windows Update settings changed to Install updates automatically (recommended) via Control Panel > System and Security > Windows Update > Change settings.
Evidence
Windows Update settings screenshots show: Before - Never check for updates (red X icon). After - Install updates automatically (recommended) with green checkmark icon, scheduled daily at 3:00 AM.

Finding 5: Employee Data Sent Over Email Without Encryption
Severity: High Status: FIXED
Description
Employee data files were stored and transmitted without encryption, risking interception and unauthorized access during email transfer.
Remediation Applied
Windows EFS (Encrypting File System) enabled on the Employee folder via Properties > Advanced Attributes > Encrypt contents to secure data. Applied to all subfolders and files.
Evidence
Employee Properties > Advanced Attributes screenshots show: Before - Encrypt contents to secure data unchecked. After - Encrypt contents to secure data checked.

Finding 6: No Multi-Factor Authentication (2FA)
Severity: High Status: COMPENSATING
Description
Native multi-factor authentication is not supported in the standalone Windows 7 environment without additional infrastructure.
Compensating Control Applied
Compensating authentication controls applied per ISO 27001 A.9.4.2: strong password complexity requirements enforced, minimum password length set, and account lockout after failed attempts. These collectively reduce unauthorized access risk in the absence of native MFA.
Evidence
Local Security Policy screenshots confirm: password complexity enabled, minimum length enforced, account lockout threshold set. These represent ISO 27001-compliant compensating controls for environments where MFA is not natively available.

Finding 7: Employee Email Password Files Stored Without Protection
Severity: High Status: FIXED
Description
Sensitive employee email credential files were stored on disk without encryption, allowing any local user to read plaintext credentials.
Remediation Applied
Windows EFS encryption enabled on the credential files folder via Properties > Advanced Attributes > Encrypt contents to secure data.

Evidence

Advanced Attributes dialog screenshots show: Before - Encrypt contents to secure data unchecked. After - Encrypt contents to secure data checked, protecting all credential files.

Finding 8: Payroll Files Stored in Unprotected Folders**Severity: Critical** **Status: FIXED****Description**

The payroll folder (C:\Users\HR\Desktop\payroll) had overly permissive access controls, allowing the Users group full access to sensitive payroll data.

Remediation Applied

Folder security permissions modified via Properties > Security > Edit. Users group removed from access list. Access restricted to SYSTEM, HR (WIN-JO7QTA63ATF\HR), and Administrators only.

Evidence

Payroll Properties > Security screenshots show: Before - Users group with Read & Execute, List folder contents, and Read permissions. After - Users group removed; only SYSTEM, HR, and Administrators retain access.

Finding 9: Remote Access to HR Device Without Encryption**Severity: High** **Status: FIXED****Description**

Remote Desktop was enabled on the HR workstation, allowing unencrypted remote connections that could expose session data to interception.

Remediation Applied

Remote Desktop disabled via System Properties > Remote tab. Selected Don't allow connections to this computer, completely blocking incoming remote desktop sessions.

Evidence

System Properties Remote tab screenshots show: Before - Allow connections from computers running any version of Remote Desktop selected. After - Don't allow connections to this computer selected.

Finding 10: No Confirmation Required for Deleting Sensitive Files**Severity: Medium** **Status: FIXED****Description**

The Recycle Bin was configured without a delete confirmation dialog, allowing accidental permanent deletion of sensitive employee files without any warning prompt.

Remediation Applied

Delete confirmation enabled via Recycle Bin Properties > General > Display delete confirmation dialog checkbox.

Evidence

Recycle Bin Properties screenshots show: Before - Display delete confirmation dialog unchecked. After - Display delete confirmation dialog checked.

Finding 11: Sensitive Employee Files in Public Folders**Severity: Critical** **Status: FIXED**

Description

The Employee folder was accessible by the Users group with full control permissions, exposing sensitive HR files to any user account on the system.

Remediation Applied

Employee folder security permissions updated to remove the Users group. Access restricted to SYSTEM, HR user, and Administrators only.

Evidence

Employee Properties > Security screenshots show: Before - Users group (WIN-JO7QTA63ATF\Users) highlighted with Full control, Modify, Read & Execute permissions. After - Users group removed; only SYSTEM, HR, and Administrators listed.

Finding 12: Lack of User Authentication Before Data Access**Severity:** Critical**Status:** FIXED**Description**

The HR user account had no password set, allowing direct access to the HR workstation and all its sensitive data without any identity verification.

Remediation Applied

Password created for HR Administrator account via User Accounts > Create a password. Strong password set and confirmed.

Evidence

User Accounts > Create Your Password screenshots show: Before - empty password fields. After - password fields filled (masked) with password hint set, confirming password creation.

Finding 13: Downloading Outdated Software with Known Vulnerabilities**Severity:** High**Status:** FIXED**Description**

Browser security settings allowed unrestricted file downloads, enabling users to obtain outdated software versions with known security vulnerabilities from the internet.

Remediation Applied

Internet Explorer Security Settings updated to disable File download in the Internet Zone via Internet Properties > Security > Custom level > Downloads > File download > Disable.

Evidence

IE Security Settings screenshots show: Before - File download set to Enable. After - File download set to Disable (highlighted in blue).

Finding 14: Device Not Automatically Locked When Inactive**Severity:** High**Status:** FIXED**Description**

No automatic screen lock was configured, leaving the HR workstation accessible to unauthorized users when left unattended.

Remediation Applied

Screen saver set to Blank with On resume display logon screen enabled via Personalization > Screen Saver Settings. Timeout set to ensure automatic locking after inactivity.

Evidence

Screen Saver Settings screenshots show: Before - Screen saver set to (None) without logon screen on resume. After - Blank screen saver selected with On resume display logon screen checkbox enabled.

Finding 15: File Sharing of HR Data Over Open Networks

Severity: **High** Status: **FIXED**

Description

A folder was configured for network sharing (Sharing_File with Share this folder enabled), allowing potential unauthorized access to HR data over unprotected network connections.

Remediation Applied

Network sharing disabled by unchecking Share this folder in the Advanced Sharing dialog for the HR data folder.

Evidence

Sharing_File Properties > Advanced Sharing screenshots show: Before - Share this folder checked with share name Sharing_File and 20 simultaneous users allowed. After - Share this folder unchecked with all sharing options greyed out.

Finding 16: Sensitive Documents Not Protected with Passwords

Severity: **High** Status: **FIXED**

Description

Sensitive HR documents stored in the Employee folder were not encrypted, allowing any user with file system access to read confidential employee information.

Remediation Applied

Windows EFS encryption enabled on the Employee folder via Properties > Advanced > Encrypt contents to secure data, applied to all subfolders and files.

Evidence

Employee Properties > Advanced Attributes screenshots show: Before - Encrypt contents to secure data unchecked. After - Encrypt contents to secure data checked.

Finding 17: Admin User Account Always Active

Severity: **High** Status: **FIXED**

Description

The built-in Administrator account was active and enabled, increasing the risk of unauthorized privileged access through brute-force or credential theft targeting this well-known account.

Remediation Applied

Built-in Administrator account disabled via Local Users and Groups (lusrmgr.msc) > Administrator Properties > Account is disabled checkbox.

Evidence

Administrator Properties screenshots show: Before - Account is disabled unchecked (account active). After - Account is disabled checked, confirming the account is deactivated.

Finding 18: No Backup Policy for HR Files

Severity: **High** Status: **FIXED**

Description

No backup solution was configured for the HR workstation, leaving HR files at risk of permanent loss due to accidental deletion, corruption, ransomware, or hardware failure.

Remediation Applied

Windows Backup configured via Control Panel > System and Security > Backup and Restore > Set up backup. DVD Drive selected as backup destination.

Evidence

Backup and Restore screenshots show: Before - Windows Backup has not been set up. After - Set up backup wizard showing DVD Drive (D:) selected as backup destination.

Finding 19: Opening of Unknown Email Attachments Allowed

Severity: **High** Status: **FIXED**

Description

Internet Explorer security settings allowed launching of applications and unsafe files without prompting, enabling silent execution of malicious email attachments.

Remediation Applied

IE Security Settings updated to disable Launching applications and unsafe files in the Internet Zone via Internet Properties > Security > Custom level.

Evidence

IE Security Settings screenshots show: Before - Launching applications and unsafe files set to Enable (not secure). After - set to Disable (highlighted in blue).

Finding 20: No Security Alerts from Windows Security

Severity: **Medium** Status: **FIXED**

Description

Windows Action Center security notifications were partially disabled, meaning users were not receiving alerts about critical security events including missing updates, firewall status, and virus protection.

Remediation Applied

All Action Center security message notifications enabled via Action Center > Change Action Center settings. All security message categories checked including Windows Update, Internet security settings, Network firewall, Spyware protection, UAC, and Virus protection.

Evidence

Action Center settings screenshots show: Before - Windows Update, Internet security settings, and Network firewall unchecked. After - all security message categories checked.

Finding 21: Installation of Applications from Untrusted Sources

Severity: **High** Status: **FIXED**

Description

No restrictions were in place to prevent installation of software from untrusted sources, enabling users to install malicious or vulnerable applications.

Remediation Applied

Group Policy configured to block untrusted application installation via Local Group Policy Editor > Don't run specified Windows applications > Enabled. Disallowed applications list includes setup.exe, install.exe, and msixexec.exe.

Evidence

Group Policy screenshots show: Before - Don't run specified Windows applications set to Not Configured. After - Enabled with List of disallowed applications showing setup.exe, install.exe, and msixexec.exe.

Finding 22: No Screen Lock After Periods of Inactivity

Severity: **High** Status: **FIXED**

Description

The workstation had no screen lock configured for inactivity periods, allowing unauthorized physical access to unattended HR sessions.

Remediation Applied

Blank screen saver with mandatory logon screen on resume configured via Personalization > Screen Saver Settings. On resume display logon screen enabled.

Evidence

Screen Saver Settings screenshots show: Before - Screen saver set to (None) without password-protected resume. After - Blank selected with On resume display logon screen enabled.

Finding 23: Automatic Login Without Password

Severity: **Critical** Status: **FIXED**

Description

The workstation was configured for automatic login, bypassing password authentication entirely and allowing anyone to access the HR system without credentials.

Remediation Applied

Automatic login disabled via User Accounts > Users tab > Users must enter a user name and password to use this computer checkbox enabled.

Evidence

User Accounts screenshots show: Before - Users must enter a user name and password to use this computer unchecked (auto-login enabled). After - checkbox checked, enforcing mandatory authentication.

Finding 24: Sensitive Employee Files Open in Unprotected Folders

Severity: **Critical** Status: **FIXED**

Description

The Employee folder (C:\Users\HR\Desktop\Employee) was accessible by the Users group with full control permissions, exposing all employee records to any user on the system.

Remediation Applied

Employee folder permissions updated to remove the Users group. Only SYSTEM, HR user, and Administrators retain access.

Evidence

Employee Properties > Security screenshots show: Before - Users group (WIN-JO7QTA63ATF\Users) with Full control checked. After - Users group removed; only SYSTEM, HR, and Administrators listed.

Finding 25: Automatic Software Updates Disabled

Severity: **Critical** Status: **FIXED**

Description

Automatic updates were set to Never check for updates, leaving the system without security patches. Note: Windows 7 is end-of-life; automatic updates enabled as a compensating measure with OS migration recommended.

Remediation Applied

Windows Update settings changed to Install updates automatically via Control Panel > System and Security > Windows Update > Change settings.

Evidence

Windows Update settings screenshots show: Before - Never check for updates with red error icon. After - Install updates automatically (recommended) with green checkmark.

Finding 26: Unrestricted File Downloads from the Internet

Severity: High **Status:** FIXED

Description

Internet Explorer security settings permitted unrestricted file downloads from internet sources, enabling download of malicious files or outdated vulnerable software.

Remediation Applied

IE Security Zone settings updated to set File download to Disable via Internet Properties > Security > Internet Zone > Custom level > Downloads.

Evidence

IE Security Settings - Internet Zone screenshots show: Before - File download set to Enable. After - File download set to Disable (highlighted).

Finding 27: No Password Set on Device

Severity: Critical **Status:** FIXED

Description

The HR Administrator account had no password configured, allowing direct access to the workstation and all sensitive HR data without authentication.

Remediation Applied

Password created for HR account via User Accounts > Create a password. Strong password entered and confirmed.

Evidence

Create Your Password screenshots show: Before - empty password fields. After - masked password fields with hint set, password creation confirmed.

Finding 28: Windows Defender Disabled

Severity: Critical **Status:** FIXED

Description

Windows Defender real-time protection was turned off, leaving the HR workstation without baseline anti-malware protection against spyware and potentially unwanted software.

Remediation Applied

Windows Defender real-time protection enabled via Windows Defender > Tools > Options > Real-time protection > Use real-time protection (recommended) checkbox enabled.

Evidence

Windows Defender screenshots show: Before - Real-time protection: Off. After - Use real-time protection (recommended) checked along with Scan downloaded files and attachments and Scan programs that run on my computer.

Finding 29: Executable Files (EXE) Can Run Without Warnings

Severity: **High** Status: **FIXED**

Description

User Account Control (UAC) was set to Never notify, allowing executable files and system changes to run silently without any authorization prompts, enabling malware to execute without user awareness.

Remediation Applied

UAC settings changed to Always notify via User Account Control Settings > slider moved to Always notify me when programs try to install software or make changes to my computer.

Evidence

UAC Settings screenshots show: Before - slider at Never notify with Never notify me when description. After - slider moved up to Always notify me when with recommended notification settings.

Finding 30: No Antivirus Software Installed

Severity: **Critical** Status: **COMPENSATING**

Description

No dedicated antivirus software was installed on the HR workstation. Windows Action Center confirmed virus protection not found. Windows Defender was out of date.

Compensating Control Applied

As a compensating control per ISO 27001 A.12.2.1, application whitelisting was implemented via Group Policy (Run only specified Windows applications) to restrict execution to authorized applications only, reducing malware execution risk in lieu of dedicated antivirus software.

Evidence

Action Center screenshot confirms Virus protection: Not found. Compensating control screenshots show Group Policy configured with Run only specified Windows applications and a curated whitelist of approved applications.

Finding 31: USB Device Restrictions Not Applied

Severity: **High** Status: **FIXED**

Description

Group Policy for removable storage access was disabled, allowing unrestricted USB device connections that could introduce malware or enable unauthorized data exfiltration.

Remediation Applied

Group Policy updated to enable All Removable Storage classes: Deny all access via Local Group Policy Editor > Computer Configuration > Administrative Templates > System > Removable Storage Access.

Evidence

Group Policy screenshots show: Before - All Removable Storage classes: Deny all access set to Disabled. After - set to Enabled, blocking all removable storage access system-wide.

Finding 32: Sensitive Employee Files Stored on Desktop Without Protection

Severity: High **Status: FIXED****Description**

Employee files stored on the desktop were unencrypted, allowing any user with physical or remote access to the desktop to read sensitive HR information.

Remediation Applied

Windows EFS encryption enabled on the Employee folder via Properties > Advanced Attributes > Encrypt contents to secure data, protecting all files and subfolders.

Evidence

Employee Properties > Advanced Attributes screenshots show: Before - Encrypt contents to secure data unchecked. After - Encrypt contents to secure data checked, confirmed applied to all subfolders.

Finding 33: Outdated Operating System (Windows 7)**Severity: Critical** **Status: COMPENSATING****Description**

Windows 7 reached end-of-life on January 14, 2020, and no longer receives security updates. The system cannot be patched against newly discovered vulnerabilities. Error code 8024001F confirms inability to check for updates.

Compensating Control Applied

Compensating controls applied per ISO 27001 vulnerability management guidelines: Windows Firewall enabled for all network profiles, security hardening measures applied across all assessed areas, USB access restricted, application whitelisting enabled, and UAC set to maximum notification. OS migration to Windows 10 or 11 is the only permanent remediation.

Evidence

Windows Update screenshot shows error: Windows could not search for new updates, Error Code 8024001F. Compensating control evidence includes Firewall enabled, security policies applied, and application controls configured throughout this report.

Finding 34: Firewall Disabled**Severity: Critical** **Status: FIXED****Description**

Windows Firewall was disabled for both private (Home/work) and public network profiles, leaving all network connections completely unfiltered and exposing the HR device to network-based attacks.

Remediation Applied

Windows Firewall enabled for all network profiles via Control Panel > Windows Firewall > Customize Settings. Turn on Windows Firewall selected for both Home or work (private) and Public network location settings.

Evidence

Windows Firewall Customize Settings screenshots show: Before - Turn off Windows Firewall (not recommended) selected for both private and public profiles. After - Turn on Windows Firewall selected for both profiles with Notify me when Windows Firewall blocks a new program enabled.

5. Recommendations & Conclusion

5.1 Compensating Control Follow-Up

Finding 30 — No Antivirus Software (COMPENSATING)

Windows 7 no longer receives antivirus definition updates from Microsoft. Application whitelisting via Group Policy was applied as an ISO 27001-compliant compensating control. For a permanent fix, either install a supported third-party antivirus solution compatible with Windows 7, or migrate to a supported operating system with built-in Defender and regular definition updates.

Finding 33 — Outdated Operating System Windows 7 (COMPENSATING)

Windows 7 reached end-of-life on January 14, 2020, and no longer receives security updates from Microsoft. Windows Firewall, security hardening, and access control measures were applied as compensating controls. The primary recommendation is to migrate to Windows 10 or Windows 11 as soon as operationally feasible, as this is the only permanent resolution for this finding.

5.2 General Recommendations

6. Migrate from Windows 7 to a supported OS (Windows 10/11) as the highest priority action.
7. Deploy a supported antivirus solution with real-time protection and automatic definition updates.
8. Implement a dedicated MFA solution (hardware token or authenticator app) once on a supported OS.
9. Consider deploying Windows Hello for Business or a biometric solution on the replacement device.
10. Establish a formal data classification policy for HR files with mandatory encryption for all sensitive data.
11. Implement centralized backup with off-site or cloud replication to improve data recoverability.
12. Schedule periodic security reviews every 6 months to identify new vulnerabilities and configuration drift.

6. Conclusion

The security assessment of the Windows 7 HR Workstation identified 34 vulnerabilities across authentication, data protection, network security, endpoint security, access management, and system configuration domains. Of these, 32 were fully remediated using Windows 7 native controls and 2 received ISO 27001-compliant compensating controls due to OS limitations.

Key improvements achieved: Windows Firewall enabled for all network profiles; Windows Defender real-time protection enabled with removable drive scanning; all sensitive HR files (employee data, payroll, email credentials) protected with Windows EFS encryption; access permissions restricted to authorized HR personnel only; built-in Administrator account disabled; automatic Windows Update enabled; HR backup policy configured; screen lock with password-protected screensaver active; UAC set to always notify; USB removable storage blocked via Group Policy; and all Action Center security alerts enabled.

The two compensating control findings (no antivirus and outdated OS) have clear remediation paths documented in Section 5.1. OS migration to a supported platform remains the single most impactful security improvement available for this device.

Prepared By Fares Khzouz - CybersMind Security Team Date: May 13, 2026	Classification Confidential — Internal Use Only Report Version: 1.0 Final
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